

Time management starts before time trouble

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

Use more time when the position changes sharply, a forcing line appears, or a major structural decision is required. Save time on familiar, low-risk moves after a brief check. Spending equally on every move is rarely efficient.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A forced recapture may need only a quick scan for intermediate moves. A pawn break that exposes both kings deserves more calculation. If you burn minutes on routine development, you may lack time for the decisive later choice.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What makes a position critical enough for extra time?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Irreversible pawn changes, king exposure, complex exchanges, and multiple plausible forcing candidates. Check your remaining clock before investing heavily.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Spend thinking time where a wrong decision changes the game most.